

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 2

APUSH-SAQ2-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 1 — Period 1: 1491–1607

Period: Period 1: 1491–1607

Theme: GEO — Geography and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of precontact North America argues that Native societies developed diverse ways of organizing political authority and economic life because they adapted to different environments. According to this interpretation, agricultural societies in the Mississippi River Valley and Southwest supported larger settled communities, while many other communities organized around seasonal movement, hunting, fishing, or trade.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of Native exchange networks argues that environmental diversity did not isolate Native societies from one another. Instead, trade routes, diplomatic relationships, and shared ceremonial practices connected distant communities long before sustained European contact.

- (a) Describe one way Native societies in North America adapted to different environments before 1492.
- (b) Explain one piece of evidence that supports the argument in Source A about environmental adaptation.
- (c) Explain one piece of evidence that supports the argument in Source B about Native exchange or interregional connection.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid environmental adaptation, such as maize agriculture in the Southwest or Mississippi Valley, irrigation in arid regions, fishing and whaling in the Pacific Northwest, bison hunting on the Great Plains, or seasonal movement in woodland environments.
- (b) 1 point: Explains evidence supporting environmental adaptation, such as Pueblo irrigation, Mississippian mound-building and agriculture, Algonquian mixed farming and hunting, Chinook trade and fishing economies, or Plains communities' use of grassland resources.
- (c) 1 point: Explains evidence supporting interregional connection, such as trade in shells, copper, obsidian, maize, ceremonial goods, shared mound-building practices, diplomatic networks, or long-distance exchange routes linking different regions.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should avoid describing Native America as one uniform society. It should connect specific Native societies to specific environments while also recognizing that trade and cultural exchange linked communities across regions before European colonization.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ2-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Period 5: 1844–1877

Period: Period 5: 1844–1877

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Californio landholder petitioning a state land commission, California, 1852.

“When the treaty was signed, we were told that property honestly held under Mexican law would be respected. Yet many of us must now defend our ranchos in courts where proceedings are conducted in English, surveys are costly, and new settlers question titles that our families have held for years. If the United States claims to bring liberty and law, it should not make those laws a burden that only the wealthy can survive.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader effects of United States expansion in the mid-nineteenth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Mexican-American War, the Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo, U.S. annexation of California, the Gold Rush, legal disputes over Mexican land grants, or westward expansion.

(b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s position as a Californio landholder influenced the argument by emphasizing treaty promises, property rights, language barriers, legal costs, and threats from incoming Anglo-American settlers.

(c) 1 point: Explains a broader effect of expansion, such as incorporation of former Mexican citizens, racial and ethnic hierarchy in the West, land dispossession, legal conflict, migration to California, debates over slavery in western territories, or U.S. continental expansion after the Mexican-American War.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the source to U.S. expansion after the Mexican-American War and avoid treating California simply as empty land settled by Americans. Strong answers will explain how law, language, property, race, and conquest shaped the experience of people already living in the region.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ2-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described chart created for this practice exam.

The chart is titled “Selected Changes in the U.S. Economy, 1980–2020.”

Indicator | 1980 | 2000 | 2020

Manufacturing share of total employment | about 20% | about 13% | about 8%

Service-sector share of total employment | about 68% | about 77% | about 80%

Households with a personal computer or internet access | very limited | growing rapidly | widespread

Imported goods as a share of consumer purchases | rising | high | very high

Union membership as a share of workers | about 20% | about 13% | about 10%

The chart notes that the figures are approximate and are intended to show broad economic trends rather than precise annual totals.

- (a) Describe one major change in the U.S. economy reflected in the chart.
- (b) Explain one factor that contributed to the economic change shown in the chart.
- (c) Explain one social or political consequence of the economic changes reflected in the chart.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as deindustrialization, growth of the service sector, expansion of computer and internet technology, increased globalization of consumer goods, or declining union membership.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as automation, outsourcing, trade liberalization, global supply chains, deregulation, computerization, decline of heavy industry, changes in corporate strategy, or competition from lower-wage manufacturing abroad.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as wage stagnation for some workers, regional decline in the Rust Belt, growth of high-skill technology jobs, political debates over trade, weakened organized labor, widening income inequality, or new forms of communication and consumer culture.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect economic data to historical causes and consequences. It should avoid simply saying that “technology improved.” Strong responses may explain how globalization and digital technology created new opportunities while also contributing to inequality, labor insecurity, and political conflict.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ2-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Period 4: 1800–1848

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which the Market Revolution transformed women's economic and social roles in the United States from 1815 to 1860.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described transportation map created for this practice exam, northeastern and midwestern United States, 1815–1845.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows major turnpikes, canals, river routes, and early railroads connecting New York, Philadelphia, Boston, Baltimore, Pittsburgh, Cincinnati, Albany, Buffalo, and Great Lakes ports. A note on the map explains that shipping times and costs declined sharply along routes connected to canals and railroads. Rural areas far from transportation corridors are shown with fewer direct links to market towns.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes how transportation networks connected farms, towns, factories, and cities, encouraging production for distant markets.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated diary entry from a farm woman in western New York, 1827; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“More cloth is bought from the store than in Mother’s day, though I still mend, churn, bake, and keep accounts of butter and eggs sent to town. The canal has made the village busy, and cash is needed more often. My husband speaks of wheat prices, but the household depends on the smaller things I sell when the merchant’s wagon arrives.”

Sourcing Cues: The diary reflects a rural household adapting to commercial agriculture and consumer goods while preserving some older forms of household labor.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated excerpt from a Lowell mill worker’s letter to her cousin, Massachusetts, 1835; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The bell orders our hours, and the room is loud with machines, yet wages give me something of my own before marriage. Some girls save for family debts, others for books or clothing. We are watched closely in the boardinghouse, and no one should think factory life is freedom without limits.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the viewpoint of a young wage-earning woman in an early textile factory system.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Factory employment table created for this practice exam, New England textile towns, 1820–1850.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Estimated Female Share of Textile Mill Operatives in Selected New England Towns.”

Year	Estimated female share of textile workers	Common worker profile
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1820	about 45%	local and regional young women
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1835	about 70%	unmarried rural women in boardinghouses
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1850	about 55%	increasing numbers of immigrant women and families
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A note beneath the table states: “Employers initially recruited young unmarried women, but the workforce changed as immigration increased and labor conditions became more contested.”

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights both the expansion of women’s wage labor and changes in the composition of the industrial workforce.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated essay from a middle-class women’s magazine, Philadelphia, 1842; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Magazine-style excerpt.

“As business draws husbands into offices, shops, and counting rooms, the home must remain a place of moral order. A wife’s influence is not measured in wages but in the character she forms, the discipline she encourages, and the Christian habits she sustains.”

Sourcing Cues: The excerpt reflects middle-class ideals often associated with separate spheres and domesticity.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Original simulated petition from women seamstresses to a city reform association, New York City, 1845; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Petition-style excerpt.

“We are paid by the piece, and the price falls whenever employers say another woman will sew for less. Work is taken into crowded rooms or into homes where candles burn late into the night. Those who praise women’s dependence should first ask how many widows and daughters live by the needle.”

Sourcing Cues: The petition reflects urban women’s wage labor, irregular employment, and criticism of assumptions about female dependency.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Described material object from a middle-class household, United States, circa 1850.

Source Type: Described material-culture source.

The object is a printed household account book sold by a commercial publisher. Its pages include spaces for recording purchases of flour, cloth, candles, coal, factory-made tools, school fees, charitable donations, and payments to domestic servants. A printed introduction says that “orderly household management” helps families practice thrift in a rapidly changing economy.

Sourcing Cues: The object shows how market goods entered domestic life and how women’s household management could be framed as moral and economic labor.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which the Market Revolution transformed women’s roles from 1815 to 1860. The thesis must make an argument, such as that the Market Revolution significantly expanded women’s wage labor and consumer roles while also strengthening middle-class domestic ideals and preserving many forms of unpaid household labor.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as industrialization, the transportation revolution, commercialization of agriculture, the Second Great Awakening, urbanization, immigration, changing family economies, or antebellum reform movements.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about wage labor, household production, consumer culture, domestic ideology, class differences, or market integration.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Lowell strikes, the Erie Canal, cult of domesticity, separate spheres ideology, Catherine Beecher, Sarah Grimké, Seneca Falls, Irish immigration, outwork, domestic service, or the rise of commercial agriculture.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze a mill worker's mixed view of wages and discipline, a magazine's middle-class audience, seamstresses' economic vulnerability, or the transportation map's emphasis on market access.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing between rural, working-class, immigrant, and middle-class women; explaining both change and continuity in women's labor; showing how unpaid domestic work remained economically important; or recognizing that domestic ideology could both limit women and justify moral authority in reform.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that the Market Revolution changed women's roles to a significant extent by drawing some women into wage labor, expanding consumer culture, and linking households to distant markets. However, it should also explain limits: many women continued unpaid domestic labor, middle-class culture praised domesticity, and working women's experiences varied by class, region, and immigration status. Useful document groupings include transportation and market integration, factory wage labor, rural household production, urban seamstress labor, middle-class domestic ideology, and household consumer management. Relevant outside evidence could include the Erie Canal, Lowell mill protests, separate spheres, Seneca Falls, or antebellum reform movements.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ2-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the late nineteenth century through the Cold War era, the United States became increasingly involved in global affairs. This involvement included overseas expansion, world wars, international institutions, economic influence, military alliances, ideological conflict, and debates at home over the proper role of the United States in the world.

Evaluate the extent to which United States involvement in global affairs changed from 1890 to 1980.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent of change in U.S. involvement in global affairs from 1890 to 1980. The thesis must make an argument about change, continuity, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to U.S. global involvement, such as industrial growth, the closing of the frontier, imperial competition, World War

I, World War II, decolonization, the Cold War, nuclear weapons, or global economic integration. Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the Spanish-American War, annexation of the Philippines, Open Door policy, World War I, the League of Nations debate, Good Neighbor policy, World War II, the United Nations, NATO, the Marshall Plan, Korean War, Vietnam War, détente, or debates over interventionism. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about continuity and change over time.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how the United States moved from regional expansion and selective overseas empire toward a sustained role as a global military, economic, and ideological power, while continuing older debates over intervention, trade, national interest, and democracy.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing between economic, military, and ideological involvement; explaining that isolationist or anti-interventionist ideas persisted even as global commitments expanded; comparing different types of intervention; or showing how domestic debates shaped foreign policy choices.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should develop a clear continuity-and-change argument rather than listing foreign policy events. It might argue that U.S. involvement changed dramatically as the nation moved from late-nineteenth-century expansion and commercial diplomacy to Cold War alliance systems and permanent global military commitments. At the same time, students should recognize continuities such as economic motives, claims of spreading democracy, strategic interests, and recurring domestic debate over intervention.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ2

· APUSH-SAQ2-001: Unit 1; Period 1: 1491–1607; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Native environmental adaptation and Native interregional exchange; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast environmental diversity with trade/diplomatic connections; historical development is precontact Native adaptation, agriculture, mobility, and exchange networks; reasoning path is comparison using geography, economy, and cultural connection; misconception targeted is treating Native societies as uniform or isolated before European contact.

· APUSH-SAQ2-002: Unit 5; Period 5: 1844–1877; perspective is Californio landholder after the Mexican-American War; source type is original simulated primary petition-style text; source viewpoint emphasizes treaty rights, land grants, legal costs, language barriers, and settler pressure; historical development is U.S. expansion into California and incorporation/dispossession of former Mexican citizens; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to conquest, property law, and borderlands; misconception targeted is portraying western expansion as settlement of empty land without legal and ethnic conflict.

· APUSH-SAQ2-003: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; perspectives include manufacturing workers, service-sector workers, technology users, consumers, unions, corporations, and regions affected by deindustrialization; non-text source type is plain-text economic change chart; visual/data pattern is manufacturing decline, service-sector growth, computer/internet spread, rising imports, and union decline; historical development is globalization, deindustrialization, digital technology, and labor change after 1980; reasoning path is continuity and change over time linking economic

restructuring to social and political consequences; misconception targeted is describing modern economic change only as technological progress without labor or regional effects.

· APUSH-DBQ2-001: Unit 4; Period 4: 1800–1848; DBQ topic is the Market Revolution’s effects on women’s economic and social roles from 1815 to 1860; document types include described transportation map, rural diary entry, Lowell mill worker letter, factory employment data table, middle-class magazine excerpt, seamstress petition, and household account-book material object; document perspectives include rural farm women, wage-earning factory women, urban seamstresses, middle-class domestic ideologues, employers/market systems, and household managers; main argument paths include wage labor expansion, market integration, consumer culture, domestic ideology, class differences, and continuity of unpaid household labor; outside evidence possibilities include Erie Canal, Lowell strikes, separate spheres, cult of domesticity, Catherine Beecher, Seneca Falls, Irish immigration, outwork, and antebellum reform; sourcing opportunities include mill worker ambivalence, middle-class magazine audience, seamstress economic vulnerability, rural household adaptation, and account book’s commercial domestic purpose; visual/data/map types include transportation network map, textile employment data table, and described material-culture household object.

· APUSH-LEQ2-001: Units 7–8; Periods 7–8 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is changing U.S. involvement in global affairs from 1890 to 1980; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include Spanish-American War, Philippines, Open Door policy, World War I, League of Nations debate, Good Neighbor policy, World War II, United Nations, NATO, Marshall Plan, Korean War, Vietnam War, détente, and debates over interventionism; complexity path is distinguishing economic, military, ideological, and diplomatic forms of involvement while recognizing persistent anti-interventionist debate; misconception targeted is assuming U.S. foreign policy changed from isolation to involvement in a simple one-directional pattern.